SOC Internship – Day 8 Notes

Topic: SOC Roles, Escalation & Workflow

Objective

Understand how a Security Operations Center (SOC) works in real-world environments, including roles, responsibilities, and escalation process.

SOC Roles & Responsibilities

L1 Analyst – Monitoring & Triage

- Monitors SIEM dashboards continuously
- Identifies and reviews security alerts
- Performs **initial triage** (True Positive / False Positive)
- Uses basic log analysis for validation
- Escalates suspicious alerts to L2 with proper context

L2 Analyst – Investigation & Response

- Performs **in-depth investigation** of escalated alerts
- Correlates logs from multiple sources
- Identifies attack type and impact
- Takes action (e.g., block IP, isolate system)
- Documents incident details clearly

L3 Analyst – Threat Hunting & Engineering

- Conducts **proactive threat hunting**
- Handles advanced threats (APT attacks)
- Creates detection rules and SIEM use cases
- Performs basic malware analysis

- Improves SOC detection capabilities

🔄 SOC Escalation Workflow

1. Alert generated in SIEM
2. L1 performs triage
3. If suspicious → escalated to L2
4. L2 investigates and confirms incident
5. If complex → escalated to L3
6. L3 performs deep analysis & enhances detection

⚠️ Key Concept: Triage vs Investigation

- **Triage (L1):**
  Quick filtering to decide if an alert is real or false
- **Investigation (L2):**
  Detailed analysis to understand attack, impact, and response

🌐 Scenario Example

Case: Multiple failed login attempts from a single IP

- **L1:** Detects alert → flags as suspicious
- **L2:** Confirms **brute force attack** → blocks IP
- **L3:** Analyzes pattern → creates rule for future detection

📝 Assignment Answers

1️⃣ Escalation Workflow (Simple Explanation)

Alerts are first checked by L1. If something looks suspicious, it is passed to L2 for deeper analysis. If the attack is advanced, L3 handles it and improves detection systems.

2 Triage vs Investigation

Triage	Investigation
Quick check	Deep analysis
Done by L1	Done by L2
Filters alerts	Confirms incidents

3 Real-World Scenario

Phishing Email Attack:

- **L1:** Detects suspicious email alert
- **L2:** Analyzes email headers and links → confirms phishing
- **L3:** Creates detection rule to block similar emails